dense and opaque to the rays of the sun. Sometimes, the clouds are so low that they seem to touch the ground. Nimbus clouds are shapeless masses of thick vapour.

71. Tropical Wet Climate is found near the equator.
The major areas are the Amazon Basin in South America, western equatorial Africa and the islands of East Indies. Significant amount of rainfall occurs in every month of the year as thunder showers in the afternoon. The temperature is uniformly high and the annual range of temperature is negligible. The maximum temperature on any day is around 30°C while the minimum temperature is around 20°C. Tropical evergreen forests with dense canopy cover and large biodiversity are found in this climate.

Tropical monsoon climate (Am) is found over the Indian sub-continent, North Eastern part of South America and Northern Australia. Heavy rainfall occurs mostly in summer. Winter is dry.

Tropical wet and dry climate occurs north and south of Af type climate regions. The wet season is shorter and the dry season is longer with the drought being more severe. Temperature is high throughout the year and diurnal ranges of temperature are the greatest in the dry season. Deciduous forest and tree- shredded grasslands occur in this climate.

72. These climates cover a very large area of the planet extending over large latitudes from 15°-60° north and south of the equator. At low latitudes, from 15°-30°, they occur in the area of subtropical high where subsidence and inversion of temperature do not produce rainfall. On the western margin of the continents, adjoining the cold current, particularly over the west coast of South America, they extend more equator- wards and occur on the coast land.

Subtropical steppe (BSh) and subtropical desert (BWh) have common precipitation and temperature characteristics. Rain occurs in short intense thundershowers in deserts and is ineffective in building soil moisture. *Fog* is common in coastal deserts bordering cold currents.

Warm temperate (mid-latitude) climates extend from 30°-50° of latitude mainly on the eastern and western margins of continents.